hotly sought by those young men, and just as hotly granted, but the military later mangled the chronology in order to present a rationale for firing. They said it came down to the fact that the cameraman from Reuters, Noor Aldin, crouched at the corner and lifted his camera to take a picture, and they took the camera to be an RPG. But if you watch the video, you see that permission to engage is asked for and granted before that, as they are ambling down the street, and the requesting voice is agitated. The whole thing was out of whack, and there wasn't a single broadcaster or print journalist in America who wanted to ask the simple question 'Why?' In a theatre of war of that sort, why is it the case that young men are trigger-happy? What is it in the culture of the Iraq conflict in particular that made pilots so keen to jump over rules of engagement and ordinary human rules of decency and carefulness to murder the innocent? TV show after TV show went out, all fronted by those blank-eyed immoralists, not one of whom chose to contradict the military opinion they'd marshalled for the viewing audience. Not one of them was willing to be a journalist.

We would later find out, over the Afghan logs, just how close American editors are to official government truth. They act pious and make a reckless bid for the high ground, pretending it's all to do with responsibility and propriety and balance, but in fact they are compromising their journalistic independence at every other turn. We will come to that. In the meantime, the editors and their correspondents in the US did nothing during this crucial moment that would compromise their popularity at the annual White House Correspondents' Dinner. They drank their cocktails with the guys on the Hill, while the mothers and wives were still weeping in Iraq. A general blindness to the true actions of the military that day was instantly endemic, as if America's inherent good could not really be questioned. But the video questions it in real time and via their own cameras. The journalists and the government spokesmen merrily entered a revolving door, and pushed each other into a clear space, but anyone who has watched 'Collateral Murder' with an open mind will know what it says.

The snap view of people who don't understand our work – who don't want to understand our work – is that we might endanger lives. But the great thrust of our work is to save lives. By making a contribution, in the public interest, to the ending of wars, by supplying journalists with the means to keep a check on the excesses of power, we aim to limit the hunger for killings, skirmishes and invasions, as well as to limit the effectiveness of